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Primary Fields: Development Economics
Secondary Fields: Behavioral Economics

Education

2021 – present	**University of Zurich** Ph.D. in Economics (expected: 2027)
2025 – 2026	**Stanford University** Visiting Student, Department of Economics
2020 – 2021	**London School of Economics and Political Science** M.Sc. Econometrics and Mathematical Economics with Distinction
2019	**McGill University** Exchange Student, Desautels Faculty of Management
2017 – 2020	**University of Amsterdam** B.Sc. Econometrics with First Class Honours

References

Lorenzo Casaburi
Department of Economics
University of Zurich
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Roberto Weber
Department of Economics
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Arun Chandrasekhar
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Stanford University
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Job Market Paper

Signaling at a Loss: Experimental Evidence on Conspicuous Consumption in Tanzania

Individuals in low-income settings invest considerable resources in signals like conspicuous attire. But signaling does not always pay off. The same signal may be beneficial in some domains and disadvantageous in others. Using two experiments in Dar es Salaam, Tanzania, I show that senders signal even when it backfires. In the first experiment, I establish that conspicuous attire enhances professional prestige, leaves credit approval unaffected, and reduces friendship formation and informal help. In the second experiment, senders believe wearing conspicuous attire is beneficial in every domain and give up about 60% of daily per-capita income to dress conspicuously even where it backfires. A structural decomposition attributes at least 74% of what they give up to wrong beliefs, rather than intrinsic motives. Senders appear to hold misperceptions about both which traits the signal conveys and how these traits are valued. Reducing the welfare losses from signaling requires correcting both.

Work in Progress

Is Social Learning Gendered?
With Kobbina Awuah, Rafael Hernández-Pachón, Urša Krenk, Sara Rabino, Daniela Santos Cárdenas, and David Yanagizawa-Drott)
Data collection complete; Funded by Swiss National Science Foundation

We ask whether individuals' economic decisions are influenced by the average behavior of peers with similar economic characteristics, and whether this response depends on gender: do women respond more strongly to information about other similar women's choices, and men to information about other similar men's? To answer these questions, we partner with a microfinance institution in Kenya, a setting with substantial gender gaps in credit demand. We embed an experiment in the institution's routine loan-application phone call. Applicants are randomly assigned to hear the average amount requested by a random sample of similar past borrowers (same area, age bracket, and sector). Depending on the treatment arm, this sample consists of male borrowers, female borrowers, or borrowers in general, with no gender specified. We estimate the causal effect of each type of information on applicants' final requested amounts, as well as on the amounts later granted and repaid. Preliminary results show that information about the amount others requested shifts credit demand and that, conditional on the amount communicated, both women and men respond more strongly to information about peers of their own gender.

Infidelity and Marital Resource Allocation
with Sara Rabino
Piloting

Infidelity is widespread in Sub-Saharan Africa, especially among men. We study the relationship between infidelity and resource allocation between spouses: when wives expect their husbands to be unfaithful, do they share less of their resources with their husbands, or more? And does the prospect of wives gaining control over resources affect husbands' infidelity? We investigate these questions in three experiments in Dar es Salaam, Tanzania. First, we use a list experiment to measure the prevalence of infidelity in local communities. Second, we run an experiment with wives, where we provide randomized information about local infidelity rates and let them choose how to split a one-year income subsidy between themselves and their husbands. Third, we run an experiment with husbands, where we inform a random sample that their wife may receive an income subsidy of varying size in the future. Six months later, we measure their infidelity through private reports from their wives.

Other Publications

Time Course of Optic Nerve Sheath Dilation: In Vitro Response Characteristics to Controlled Pressure Elevations (with Hans-Christian Hansen and Knut Helmke)
Journal of the Neurological Sciences, 2022, 441, 120358.

Teaching & Supervision

2023 – 2024	**University of Zurich**
	Introductory Mathematics (Ph.D.)
	Advanced Microeconomics 2 (M.A.)
	Thesis Supervision in Development Economics (M.A.)
2018 – 2020	**Fibonacci Studiebegeleiding, Amsterdam**
	Multivariable Analysis (B.Sc.)
	Linear Algebra (B.Sc.)
	Calculus (B.Sc.)
2018 – 2020	**University of Amsterdam**
	Operations Research (B.Sc.)
	Calculus (B.Sc.)

Grants & Awards

2026	Swiss RE Fund for Research in Development Economics, University of Zurich *(10,000 CHF – top up, max. amount)*
2026	GRC Short Grant, University of Zurich *(5,000 CHF, max. amount)*
2026	Director's Grant, University of Zurich *(10,000 CHF, max. amount)*
2025	URPP – Equality of Opportunity Research Grant, University of Zurich *(25,000 CHF, max. amount)*
2025 – 2026	Doc.Mobility, University of Zurich, Switzerland (*40,308 CHF)*
2024 – present	URPP – Equality of Opportunity, University of Zurich (*Senior Scholarship)*
2023 – 2024	URPP – Equality of Opportunity, University of Zurich (*Junior Scholarship)*
2024	GRC Travel Grant *(2,200 CHF)*
2023	Swiss RE Fund for Research in Development Economics, University of Zurich *(7,500 CHF – piloting, max. amount)*
2021	Studienstiftung des Deutschen Volkes, Germany *(10,000 Euros)*

Research Experience

2022 – 2023	**University of Zurich** Research Assistant to Prof. David Yanagizawa-Drott Research Assistant to Prof. Lorenzo Casaburi Research Assistant to Prof. Marek Pycia
2019 – 2022	**University Hamburg-Eppendorf** Research Assistant to Prof. Hans-Christian Hansen

Workshops & Conferences

2026	NEUDC (Cornell, upcoming), NCBEE (Helsinki), DENS (Basel), ESA (Barcelona), PacDev (Davis), Symposium on the Role of Social Preferences and Social Norms on Economic Life (Zurich)
2025	URPP Conference on Gender Issues in Education and the Labor Market (Zurich), Advanced Course in Social Norms and Development (Gerzensee)
2024	Workshop on Social Norms (Zurich), Summer School in Theory Based Experiments (CALTECH)

Academic & Community Service

2024 – present	Cohort Representative, Student Life Committee at University of Zurich
2024	Organizer, Workshop on Social Norms at University of Zurich/ETH
2023 – present	Volunteer, Graduate Applications International Network (GAIN)
2023 – 2024	Organisational Lead, Third-Year Seminar at University of Zurich
2018 – 2020	Student Fellow, Programme Committee Econometrics at University of Amsterdam
2018	Chairwoman, International Student Committee Econometrics at University of Amsterdam

Miscellany

Software: R, Qualtrics, Stata, Python, LaTeX, Microsoft Office

Languages: German (Native), English (Proficient), French (Fluent)

Citizenship: Germany